



Prepared by Fluera Luxe

Cetaphil (Sun range)

Sunscreen & Skin care



Introduction (Initial Launch)



We analyze Cetaphil’s sun care line as a brand that is currently in the
Maturity Stage of its Product Life Cycle.



Cetaphil, as a master brand was introduced decades ago by dermatologists. Its sun care line was launched later, leveraging the existing brand equity. It entered the market with a clear value proposition: gentle, non-irritating, and effective sun protection for sensitive skin. Initial awareness was built through dermatologist recommendations, clinical trials, and word-of-mouth among patients with skin conditions like eczema or rosacea.



Market strategies used



Product:

Focused on core benefits: fragrance-free, non-comedogenic, and hypoallergenic formulas.

Price:

Adopted a competitive/value-based pricing strategy, positioning itself as a premium drugstore brand, more affordable than luxury dermatological brands but more expensive than basic mass-market sunscreens.



Promotion:

Relied almost exclusively on professional endorsements from dermatologists and pharmacists. Minimal mass-market advertising.

Distribution:

Initially focused on drugstores, pharmacies, and clinical settings.



Growth (Market Expansion)



The Cetaphil master brand gained immense trust and became a household name for gentle skincare.

The sun care line rode this wave, experiencing increasing sales as consumers sought out trusted brands for daily sun protection.

The product line expanded from a single SPF lotion to include various formats like lightweight fluids, mineral options, and face-specific sunscreens.

Marketing Strategies Used

Product:

Introduced line extensions ex. SPF 15, 30, 50, moisturizers with SPF) to cater to different needs.

Promotion:

Began broader marketing efforts, including in-store promotions, featured placements in drugstores, and later, digital marketing targeting individuals searching for "sunscreen for sensitive skin."

Distribution:

Expanded from pharmacies to major retailers (Watsons), online marketplaces (lazada, shopee).

Maturity (Current Stage)

Characteristics Showing This Stage

Market Saturation:

The market for sensitive skin sunscreen is crowded with competitors (e.g., La Roche-Posay, Aveeno, Vanicream, and even newer brands copying the "gentle" claim). Cetaphil is an established, well-known player. Stable but Flat

Growth:

Sales are likely stable and high due to brand loyalty, but rapid growth has slowed. The primary goal is to defend market share from competitors, not to find new customers.



Maturity (Current Stage)

Characteristics Showing This Stage

Price Competition:

It frequently faces price competition and is often part of "buy one, get one 50% off" promotions at drugstores.

Product is Well-Established:

It is considered a classic, reliable, and "safe" choice for consumers and professionals alike.



QUESTIONS:

WHAT

Characteristics show that the product is in this stage?

It shows that it is in the Maturity stage because they focus on their internal/incremental improvements rather than radical innovation.

WHAT

Marketing strategies (pricing promotion distribution, product improvements)

Should be used at this stage?

Product: Focus on incremental improvements

Promotion: Heavy impression reminder advertising

Pricing: Use of competitive pricing to encourage brand loyalty.



QUESTIONS:

WHAT Challenges does the product face at this stage

Intense Competition in other brand that is also dermatologist
recommended

IF The product is in the decline stage, how can it be revived?
(or should it be phased out)?

Product relaunch
Market development
Repositioning shift





Thank you

